

CPA Year-End Handoff Checklist

Print this. Tick boxes as you gather. Hand the whole stack to your CPA — they'll thank you.

1. INCOME DOCUMENTS (gather originals or PDFs)

- **All 1099-NEC forms**
From every client or platform that paid you \$600+ this year. Should arrive by Jan 31.
- **All 1099-K forms**
From payment processors (Stripe, PayPal, Venmo for business, Uber, DoorDash, Etsy, etc.). Threshold is \$5,000 for 2025; check current year.
- **All W-2s**
Day-job income, if any. Box 2 (federal tax withheld) is the number that affects your quarterly calculation.
- **All 1099-INT, 1099-DIV, 1099-B**
Interest, dividends, brokerage activity — even small amounts count.
- **K-1s (if a partner in a partnership/S-corp)**
These often arrive late — March is common. Don't file without them.
- **Anything else with "1099" in the name**
1099-G unemployment, 1099-R retirement, 1099-MISC rents/royalties, etc.

2. RECORDS YOU PRODUCED THIS YEAR

- **Quarterly payment log (from the Quarterly Tax System)**
All four quarterly payments — date paid, amount, federal vs state, confirmation numbers. Form 1040 line 26 needs this total.
- **Mileage log (if you used standard mileage)**
From the Mileage Tracker or your own log. CPA needs total business miles, total miles all year, and your business-use %.
- **Income & expense ledger or QuickBooks/spreadsheet export**
Categorized profit & loss for the year. Schedule C needs this broken out by category (advertising, supplies, software, etc.).
- **Bank & credit card statements (business)**
12 months of statements for any account where business money flowed. CPA may not need them all — but if they ask, you're ready.
- **Receipts for major business purchases (>\$500)**
Especially if you might depreciate them (computer, camera, vehicle). Smaller receipts are usually fine to keep summarized.
- **Home office square footage (if claiming)**
Total sq ft of the home AND of the dedicated work area. CPA picks simplified vs actual method based on these numbers.

3. PERSONAL INFO YOUR CPA NEEDS

- **Social Security numbers (you, spouse, dependents)**
Yes — even if your CPA "already has them." Confirms nothing changed.
- **Bank routing & account numbers (for direct refund)**
Speeds refunds by 2–4 weeks vs paper check.

■ **Estimated payments made under spouse's name (joint filers)**

Easy thing to miss — IRS posts these by SSN; mismatch can delay or lose them.

■ **Last year's return (if new CPA)**

First page especially — last year's AGI determines this year's safe harbor multiplier.

4. ASK YOUR CPA THESE QUESTIONS

■ **"Do I qualify for the QBI deduction this year?"**

The Qualified Business Income deduction is worth 20% off your business income for most self-employed under the income limits. Often missed by first-time filers.

■ **"Am I on track to hit the SE income threshold where S-corp election makes sense?"**

Generally above \$40–50K of profit, S-corp can save you on SE tax. Important to plan a YEAR ahead.

■ **"What should my Q1 estimated payment be next year?"**

Lock this in before you leave the meeting. Update the Setup tab in your Quarterly Tax System the moment you get home.

■ **"Any deductions I'm missing?"**

Common ones overlooked by side-hustlers: phone (business %), professional development, business insurance, retirement contributions (SEP-IRA, solo 401k).

Educational tool only — not legal or tax advice. Your CPA may need additional items based on your specific situation. Made by SideHustleGuard · sidehustleguard.com